EILEEN WANI WINGFIELD

1920–2014

As a young Aboriginal woman in Australia, Wingfield herded cattle and sheep with her father and sister. In the early 1980s she lay down in front of bulldozers at Canegrass Swamp in opposition to construction of the Olympic Dam uranium mine. Later, Wingfield teamed up with Eileen Kampakuta Brown and other Aboriginal elders to campaign against the government's proposals to dump nuclear waste in South Australia. The women toured the country, speaking at meetings to highlight the dangers of the dump, which they feared could grow as foreign governments and corporations saw an opportunity to dispose of their radioactive waste.

See also: Pollution

EUGENIE CLARK

1922–2015

Known as the "Shark Lady" for her research on shark behavior, Clark was a Japanese-American marine ecologist and a pioneer in the use of scuba diving for scientific research—she undertook many dives around Florida's Cape Haze Marine Laboratory, where she worked alongside other female ecologists such as Sylvia Earle. Clark made several key discoveries about sharks and fish, and was a major advocate of marine conservation. In 1955, she founded the Mote Marine Laboratory, which works to protect shark species, preserve coral reefs, and found sustainable fisheries.

See also: Animal behavior